



MONTHLY UPDATE

Burkina Faso: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-05 · 51 systems and instruments tracked, 14 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-05 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The legislature voted a data-protection law and an organic law merging the broadcasting regulator with the data-protection commission on 3 August 2026; neither is promulgated. Two days earlier, automated traffic enforcement went live and detected 1,099 offences in its first twelve hours. The Council of Ministers adopted three decrees on 30 July – mass biometric enrolment, critical-infrastructure classification and security-audit accreditation – and the digital ministry put 120 externally hosted public platforms on the record for the first time.

Infrastructure

The Council of Ministers of 30 July adopted two decrees applying the 2024 information-systems security law: one identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and one fixing periodic security audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. The law had asserted both duties since July 2024 with no machinery attached.

At the Prime Minister's mid-year review of 25 July the digital ministry reported 46.7% physical execution of its 2026 objectives contract, said the architecture of the replacement public-administration network is finalised with suppliers' bids under evaluation, and said negotiations on admitting a satellite operator are advancing. That operator remains unlicensed.

A wholly domestic commercial hosting provider launched on 31 July with more than 600 domain names, more than 196 web hostings and 98% availability at launch – the vendor's own figures, with capacity, tier and certification unstated. The regulator ran a four-day workshop with territorial authorities from 29 June to 2 July, naming local opposition and misinformation as continuing brakes on tower rollout. At an address-protocol forum on 3 July the regulator and operators again called for a migration plan with a firm calendar; none is adopted.

Digital public infrastructure

Automated traffic enforcement entered operation at midnight on 1 August after a pilot from 7 April, reading plates against the vehicle database, serving fines by message with a link to the national payments rail, and immobilising vehicles for non-payment within a month. It [logged 1,099 offences between midnight and noon that day](#) and five payments. Neither held account reports a legal basis, retention rule or data-protection authorisation; the justification given is 15,614 road accidents in 2025.

The Council of Ministers of 30 July also [adopted the decree organising mass registration for the unique electronic identifier](#), through committees run entirely by public structures so that fingerprint and iris data stay in-country, with mass enrolment targeted before end-2026. Enrolment had not begun as at 5 August, and the decree states no target, budget or supervisory authority. A Nigerien technical mission was received on 30 July.

Two services launched on 21 July: an estate-agency register with a compulsory card applied for and tracked wholly online and commissions capped, and a pension formalities portal presented as improving data exchange between three administrations rather than as a web front end.

The regional instant-payment rail moved its deadlines rather than its coverage: the central bank [extended connection to 30 September 2026 for banks and payment institutions and 30 June 2027 for microfinance](#), with 80 institutions connected union-wide at 24 June and 74 more in test.

Governance and regulation

On 3 August the legislature [voted the personal-data protection bill and the organic law creating a merged communications and data-protection authority](#). The new law prohibits and sanctions processing without consent, indexes administrative fines to turnover excluding tax and scales them by gravity, and prohibits transferring sensitive data abroad. The merged authority takes the broadcasting regulator's mandate and the data-protection commission's, and is given its own rule-making power with artificial intelligence named specifically. Neither text is held, neither is promulgated, and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

Asked in plenary where artificial intelligence sat in the new law, the justice minister said it was already integrated, notably through the prohibition on transferring sensitive data abroad, with the national roadmap intended to become dedicated regulation later.

The Council of Ministers of 23 July restricted recourse to the fast-track procurement route to sovereignty, strategic character, threats to public order or service continuity, and humanitarian consequences of insecurity — at the same sitting that used the route for a schools package of about FCFA 38bn. It also replaced the 2017 decree governing the non-profit register, fixing for the first time a retention period for that data after dissolution, and converted the trade single window's operator into a state company.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Capacity-building at the top of the state was the month's artificial-intelligence activity. The Prime Minister's office ran a two-day session for its senior managers on 13 and 14 July on management tools for ethical and responsible artificial intelligence, a second round after a first for all staff. A parliamentary technology body [trained about thirty lawmakers on 16 July](#) to prepare their review of future legislation.

At a regional digital salon on 14 to 16 July, the monetary union's commission announced it would prepare a community artificial-intelligence strategy, counting this country among four member states already holding a national one — a count another source published five days earlier contradicts. An operator pitched credit scoring built on mobile-money transaction patterns at the same event; no model-disclosure duty or contestation route for an automated refusal is on file. Six francophone West African states adopted common governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The month's inclusion activity was training and consumer protection delivered by the state's promotion agency rather than its regulator. A financial inclusion agency and a payments operator opened a 72-hour financial-education campaign on 28 July, extending a partnership running since 2025 to four cities. An operator digital centre marked five years of operation at a ministerial visit on 4 July.

The Council of Ministers of 23 July approved a revised finance law raising both receipts and spending while leaving the deficit unchanged, and recorded 47.30% budget execution at 30 June. The same sitting approved the statutes of a technology academy, with no intake, curriculum or budget on record.

A digital acceleration project stated on 13 July that it will support connectivity to [1,000 localities in 2026](#) against nearly 2,000 still without mobile or internet service, expected to benefit one and a half to two million people, most of them rural. No regulator or ministry primary states whether that count is of telecom sites or of localities served.

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